Power view is even more recent, being no more than two decades old. The differences apart, what is common to the three perspectives is the idea that the world is organized hierarchically.

Tianxia

China's modern tianxia view has gained considerable attention since the Chinese philosopher Zhao Tingyang's writings began to appear in 2005. Zhao's influential work *The Tianxia System: An Introduction to the Philosophy of a World Institution* spread an awareness of the ancient philosophy of tianxia and provided a modern interpretation relevant to China's governance but crucially also the conduct of its external relations and the nature of international order.[99] As with any great philosophical system, differences exist over its meaning: is tianxia a cosmopolitan view of the world that emphasizes justice in governance provided by a powerful moral authority (irrespective of whether that authority is China); or is it the rationale for a strong China resuming its place as the centre of the world and dispensing order to lesser entities? In either case, is the central authority, whether Chinese or other, an object of reverence or fear? Does authority depend on its moral superiority and munificence or on its material inducements and coercive abilities?

The operational part of tianxia in international relations is the idea of a tributary system. A dominant power receives 'tribute' from smaller powers and dispenses legitimacy, order, and even material benefits to its tributaries. It does not demand tribute; it attracts it by its splendour. In whatever way tianxia is conceptualized, at base it as also the tributary system is a hierarchical organization of political and international life. The most telling argument for hierarchy, one that exists everywhere and not just in China, is that by slotting people and groups and assigning clear obligations and expectations, it produces stability and satisfaction. In modern political life, hierarchy is regarded with suspicion, but in tianxia and the tributary system and other graded systems, it is the basis for justice and peace.